

Uddannelsesmuligheder i Danmark



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Costa Rica. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's a great and exciting stage you're at — congratulations on finishing primary school! Since you're 16 and have completed primary school in Denmark, you're now at a point where you can choose among several different educational paths depending on your interests, strengths, and future goals. Let me break down your options and share some recommendations:

Main educational paths after primary school (folkeskole) in Denmark

Since you're fluent in Danish and have a background in Denmark's school system, you can seamlessly access these options:

Gymnasiale uddannelser (upper secondary school / general education)

- **STX (Alment gymnasium)** – broad academic education with focus on humanities, social sciences, and natural sciences.
- **HHX (Handelsskole)** – focus on business, economics, and marketing.
- **HTX (Teknisk gymnasium)** – focus on technical and scientific subjects.
- **HF (Højere forberedelseseksamen)** – a shorter, more practical general education (often for slightly older students, but possible at 16).

✓ *Recommended if:* You enjoy academic subjects and want to keep your options open for university later.

Erhvervsuddannelser (vocational education and training / VET)

- You combine school with practical work experience (apprenticeship) in a trade (e.g. carpentry, electrician, chef, hairdresser, IT support).
- Duration: usually 3-5 years depending on the trade.

✓ *Recommended if:* You prefer hands-on learning and want to enter the job market with a skilled trade, or later continue to higher vocational or technical education.

Kombinationsuddannelser (EUX)

- Combines VET (a trade) with academic courses, giving you both a trade qualification and a general upper secondary diploma.

✅ *Recommended if:* You want both practical skills *and* the option for further university or higher education later.

Factors to consider in your choice

Since you have a multicultural background (Costa Rican parents + Danish upbringing), you might also want to think about:

-  Whether you want to include language studies (e.g. Spanish at STX or HHX).
-  Whether you're interested in international opportunities — STX, HHX, or EUX can prepare you well for studying abroad later.
-  Your learning style — do you prefer theoretical/academic learning (gymnasiale uddannelser) or practical/experiential learning (VET/EUX)?

✨ My recommendations (based on what you've shared)

If you want to **keep doors open** for university and maybe study internationally or combine your Danish-Costa Rican background:

➡ **STX** – broad, flexible, strong preparation for university (and you can often choose Spanish, which might be nice given your heritage).

If you are interested in **business, trade, or entrepreneurship**:

➡ **HHX** – you can focus on economics, international trade, marketing — and it could be exciting given Denmark's and Costa Rica's business connections.

If you're drawn to **practical learning + academics**:

➡ **EUX** – great if you like doing as well as thinking, and want a skill + academic qualification.

If you **already know you want to work in a specific trade**:

➡ **VET (erhvervsuddannelse)** – best if you're motivated by practical work.

Final tip

It's a good idea to:

- Visit **uddannelsesmesser (education fairs)**.
- Attend **open house events** at gymnasiums or vocational schools.
- Talk to a **UU-vejleder (youth education counselor)** — they can help tailor advice to your situation.

If you want, you can tell me:

👉 What subjects you enjoy most?

👉 Do you like practical or theoretical learning better?

👉 Any career ideas (even vague ones)?

That way I can give you a more personalized recommendation! 🚀